

ions

An opportunity consult should be conducted with Strategic Account Leaders (SAEs) at least once a month for every \$250K+ opportunity in stage 3 or greater for current quarter and next quarter. For AEs with fewer than three \$50K+ opportunities, consider conducting monthly opportunity consults for their top 3 opportunities or run group review sessions at leadership discretion, where possible.

Commercial Area Sales Manager Expectations

An opportunity consult should be conducted with Mid Market Account Executives (AEs) at least once a month for every \$100K+ opportunity. This is the minimum global standard, and geographic and segment specific teams can and should aim to exceed these expectations by extending the command plan process to lower deal thresholds where appropriate.

Additional Resources

Command Plan templates

- Blank template
- Template with helper text
- Sample Command Plan

Opportunity Consults

- Opportunity Consults Handbook page
- Opportunity Coaching Guide

SECTION: sales/command-of-the-message/metrics.md

Overview

Many sales reps find the Metrics component of the Command of the Message customer conversation framework to be a difficult one. To learn more, check out the Force Management blog, "Why Sales Reps Struggle with Metrics in the Sales Conversation." One of the most common challenges is that many customers don't have good metrics, they aren't measuring, and they may not know what to measure. Check out the below video from Nico Ochoa (Strategic Account Executive, US West).

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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```

Below are some additional challenges your peers have shared.

- Customers may be reluctant to share metric details for negotiation purposes (they don't want to admit how compelling of an ROI GitLab can provide!)
- Sales team members struggle with finding the perfect proof point(s) to demonstrate how we've

- helped similar organizations (e.g. similar industry, business challenge, geography, etc.)
- Difficulty connecting Metrics with Positive Business Outcomes (PBOs)
 - Metrics, if used in the wrong way, can get complex and technical

The following sections outline practical tips to help demystify the Metrics conversation and overcome the challenges identified above.

Embrace Your Role as the Trusted Advisor

Keep in mind that many customers may not understand why their DevOps initiatives are not delivering desired or optimal results. Assist them in their diagnosis and lead with insights to help them accomplish their Positive Business Outcomes (PBOs). Listen to how Nico approaches initial discovery conversations.

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Below is just one example of how you could leverage Nico's approach to open the conversation with your customers to begin to understand the specific challenges they are experiencing.

"If you're like other organizations we speak with, below are some of the common challenges they encounter in their software development life cycle:

1. There is still significant room for improvement in their DevOps processes
1. They lack visibility across their entire Software Development Life Cycle
1. They are unable to clearly measure and assess developer productivity
1. Silos persist between Development, Security, and Operations teams

Are any of these true for your organization?"

Another critical way to embrace your role as a trusted advisor is to become and stay intimately familiar with the specific problems that GitLab helps to solve. Watch the below video and master your knowledge of GitLab's customer use cases.

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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Be a Good Storyteller

The best Metrics conversations are STORIES that articulate quantifiable measurements and proof of the business benefits of the solution to the customer's problem(s). John May (Strategic Account Executive, US East) leverages this DORA State of DevOps 2019 slide to emotionally appeal to individuals' desire to become elite performers and highlight relevant success stories of organizations (Ticketmaster, Verizon Connect, Paessler AG, and more) that have become Elite Performers by adopting and expanding their GitLab footprint. Learn more from John in this Art Behind Command of the Message sales enablement videocast (GitLab internal only, Oct 2019, 26

minutes).

Listen to how Nico Ochoa (Strategic Account Executive, US West) explains the value of GitLab by talking in terms of a software factory and applying lean manufacturing principles. More specifically, GitLab applies these principles to take waste out of the process of developing and deploying applications to increase operational efficiencies, deliver better products faster, and reduce security and compliance risk.

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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As a follow on to the above, be sure to familiarize yourself with GitLab's Value Stream Management (VSM) & Value Stream Analytics capabilities. Effectively articulating these capabilities plays to two of GitLab's key differentiators:

1. Single Application for Entire DevOps Lifecycle, and
1. End-to-End Insight and Visibility

Watch the below video and check out GitLab's Value Stream Management solutions page to learn more. In addition, access short customer-facing VSM videos in the Agile Management section of the Learn@GitLab page.

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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Know the Difference Between Economic and Technical Metrics

Economic Metrics

Economic metrics highlight how your solution attaches to the customer's large strategic initiatives.

- Economic metrics typically align to one or more of three customer value drivers
- To help you document your customer's ROI of adopting GitLab, use the GitLab ROI Model
 - Watch the video below
 - Check out the GitLab Standard ROI Models enablement webcast (36 minutes, Sept 2020)
 - GitLab Standardized ROI Model (GitLab internal only)
 - Standardized GitLab ROI Model presentation (GitLab internal only)
- Check out the Forrester Total Economic Impact Study Handbook page
 - Watch the Forrester TEI Report webcast (1 hour, July 2020, internal only) featuring Forrester analysts
 - Check out the online Forrester TEI Estimator/Calculator
 - More resources in the Handbook page referenced above!

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
</figure>

Listen to Nico Ochoa (Strategic Account Executive, US West) describe his role in helping a large tech firm be able to measure success and improve business outcomes (GitLab internal only, June 2020, 3 minutes).

Technical Metrics

Technical metrics highlight measurable results that prove the solution's capabilities.

- Review Getting Started with Agile Metrics
- Consider reading "Accelerate: The Science of Lean Software and DevOps: Building and Scaling High Performing Technology Organizations"

Hear what Nico says about cycle time compression, helping organizations do more with less, and improving developer satisfaction.

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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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allowfullscreen="true"> </iframe>
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To better navigate Metrics conversations, listen to the 7-minute Force Management Metrics in the Sales Conversation podcast and implement these practices:

1. Recognize that your solution impacts decision-makers in different ways and their reasoning for choosing your solution over alternatives is also different
1. Understand what each stakeholder/decision-maker cares about and help them (especially your Champions) understand how your solution impacts
 - What they care about, and
 - What other stakeholders/decision-makers care about
1. Be sure you understand what technical metrics align to the value drivers your customer cares about most (see next section)

Connect Metrics with Positive Business Outcomes

Link your technical buyers to the metrics and their role in driving the positive business outcomes. If you can emotionally connect those technical metrics-focused buyers on the impact they have for the entire company, they will be better able to internally sell the importance of your solution. With economic or non-technical buyers, lead with and continue to reinforce the Positive Business Outcomes your solution will deliver and help them understand how those Positive Business Outcomes are associated with the project's technical metrics.

| :-----: | ----- |

| Increase Operational Efficiencies | - Lower costs (license, FTEs and compute) of development
 - Increase developer/team productivity
 - Reduce cycle time (lead time)
 - Increase deployment frequency
 - Reduce change failure rate
 - Reduce MTTR (mean time to recover/restore)
 - Improve developer satisfaction and retention |

| Deliver Better Products Faster | - Improve revenue, of customers, and/or market share
 - Increase developer/team productivity
 - Reduce cycle time (lead time)
 - Increase deployment frequency
 - Reduce change failure rate
 - Reduce MTTR (mean time to recover/restore) |

| Reduce Security and Compliance Risk | - Decrease % of critical security vulnerabilities that escaped development
 - increase the % of code scanned
 - improve audit pass rate
 - Reduce time spent on audits and/or compliance adherence efforts
 - Reduce mean time to resolve security vulnerabilities |

Know Your Proof Points

- Reference and leverage the proof points listed in the GitLab Value Framework and in slides 22 and 23 of the Customer Deck (see the Command of the Message Core Content) (internal only)
- Familiarize yourself with GitLab's Proof Points to the point where you can talk about various success stories in a conversational manner
- Check out the short videos in the Customer Success Stories playlist on GitLab Unfiltered (GitLab internal-only)
- Listen to the Maximize the Effectiveness of Proof Points podcast (12.5 minutes)

Embrace the Tension

- Early in the sales process, a difficult metrics conversation is a good sign that the customer wants and needs a trusted advisor (you!!) to help them with their DevOps adoption journey. Leverage relevant proof points to instill confidence that GitLab is uniquely suited to help them achieve their desired outcomes.
- As the opportunity progresses, customers will ask for and expect discounting because that's what they've been trained to do. Maintain conviction in and continue to reiterate the VALUE of the GitLab solution and the defensible differentiators that make GitLab the best choice.

Leverage Metrics to Create Urgency

By understanding your customer's desired outcomes and their strategic business initiatives, be sure you fully understand and can articulate the answer to the following questions:

1. Why should the customer buy anything?
1. Why should the customer buy now?
1. Why should the customer buy the GitLab solution?
1. What is the cost and impact to the customer of doing nothing?
1. Is there a compelling event that impacts any of the above?

And once you have identified compelling answers to these questions, continue to reiterate and reinforce that value with key influencers and decision makers (keeping in mind that different stakeholders may care about different things).

Assess the Health of Your Metrics

Periodically, conduct a critical review of the below questions. This can be done via a self-assessment and/or with your account team, peers, mentors, or your manager. In some instances, you may even consider reviewing this with your Champion.

1. Has the customer bought into the identified metrics?
1. Are the metrics aligned with the desired business outcomes?
1. Are your Champions leveraging the identified metrics?
1. Are the identified metrics in the customer's business justification and/or decision criteria?
1. Has the economic buyer made reference calls based on the identified metrics?

Practice, Practice, Practice

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Purposeful practice (combined with on-the-job experience) leads to skill mastery. Read the article. Michael Jordan became the greatest basketball player of all time, at least in part, because he worked hard at practicing, and perfecting his craft. Practice having the metrics conversation with yourself, with a peer, a mentor, your manager, or other. As you become more comfortable and confident, positive results will follow.

<!-- vale handbook.InclusionGender = YES -->

SECTION: sales/command-of-the-message/opportunity-consults.md

Overview

Opportunity consults are deal reviews that focus on helping a sales team member maximize the likelihood of winning and securing the customer's business. They are based on a joint inspection of the "health" of the opportunity's Command Plan and a 2-way dialogue to identify and commit to specific actions that aim to increase the likelihood of success. During every opportunity consult, the sales manager should assess whether or not the sales team member is able to do the below and provide coaching to help the sales team member address gaps identified.

1. Concisely explain the opportunity background leveraging information from the Opportunity Overview fields
1. Describe the customer's pain points and desired outcomes
1. Highlight challenges or gaps in qualification aligned to the MEDDPICCC opportunity qualification framework
1. Articulate a Close Plan (or a prioritized set of actions to help formulate a Close Plan)
1. Identify the biggest opportunity risk(s) and action(s) to mitigate those risks

Opportunity Consult Format

Below is a general recommendation of the format and flow of an opportunity consult.

| Step (duration) | Description |

| ----- | ----- |

| Manager Set-Up (5 minutes) | - Set expectations of the call by stating the purpose, process and payoff of the session |

| Seller-Led Opportunity Overview (10 minutes uninterrupted) | - Job aid: Opportunity Qualifier

 - Provides brief opportunity background (e.g., relevant account history, recent changes on opportunity)
 - Describes current deal state (e.g., sales process stage, forecast stage, key business issues, compelling event)
 - Identifies gaps in Mantra, MEDDPIC, and additional challenges for discussion |
| Manager Consult (30 minutes) | - Job aid: Opportunity Coaching Guide
 - Ask open-ended, two-sided questions around focus areas to inspect (in a good, helpful way) the opportunity
 - Provide relevant feedback and coaching based on the identified gaps and challenges
 - Assist the seller in defining an action plan and exactly "how" to execute on the next steps |
| Manager + Seller Agree to Action Plan (5 minutes) | - Seller recaps opportunity-specific sales strategy
 - Seller documents next steps/critical actions in CRM or via email to manager |

Opportunity Consult Coverage

Regular opportunity consults on strategic deals are a linchpin to successfully reinforcing and sustaining the critical skills and behaviors underlying Command of the Message and MEDDPIC that maximize the likelihood of winning and securing the customer's business. To improve win rates, forecast accuracy, and predictability, front-line sales managers should conduct at least one opportunity consult every 30 days for any and all opportunities that warrant a full Command Plan as outlined here. Opportunity Consult Coverage is a pair of metrics that measures how well sales managers are adhering to the above policy. More specifically, Opportunity Consult Coverage measures:

1. The % of Stage 3+ opportunities at or above defined ARR thresholds (\$250K+ for Enterprise, \$100K+ for Mid-Market) that have had a documented opportunity consult (as measured by the Manager Review field in the Command Plan) in the last 30 days.
1. Same as above parameters but calculated based on opportunity pipeline value (versus opportunity count)

The higher the Opportunity Consult Coverage, the greater confidence sales leadership will have in the accuracy of the forecast.

Opportunity Consult Coverage Dashboards

- Enterprise Sales (internal only)
- Mid-Market Sales (internal only)
- SMB Sales (internal only)

Best Practices

- Conduct regular weekly Opportunity Consults with each rep on your team to review Command Plans for strategic opportunities
- Focus on continually driving higher fidelity Command Plans through each customer communication/interaction
- Coaches/managers should first seek to understand the current level of understanding of those they are coaching before explaining key or misunderstood concepts
- Coaches/managers should encourage reps to
 1. Commit to specific, concrete, actionable next steps (e.g., "I am going to do X, Y, and Z to test my Champion" instead of "I am going to test my Champion") and

1. Document action items in a shared way (e.g. document in Salesforce or send a summary wrap-up communication after the meeting)
- Consider including key account team members (e.g. SAs and CSMs) in Opportunity Consults from time to time to facilitate improved transparency and collaboration
 - Coach sales team members on the best practices related to the Close Plan within a Command Plan
 - Close plans should be updated in real time and, at minimum, on a weekly basis for later-stage (Stage 4+) deals
 - Time stamp the latest update at the top with the date of the refresh so each line item starts with a specific date
 - Liberally use () or between line items or at the end of line items to denote Close Plan gaps that the sales team member intends to address during the next communication with the prospect/customer
 - Keep documented actions as crisp and succinct as possible; endeavor to keep it on one line so as not to make it a blog
 - Refer to the Paper Process field when appropriate so efforts aren't duplicated

Additional Resources

Familiarize yourself with the Command of the Message and MEDDPICC Sales Manager Materials (internal only).

SECTION: sales/command-of-the-message/proof-points.md

Overview

The original and internal-to-GitLab proof points Google Doc is online, here while some parts of this handbook page are being approved for publication.

Proof points with third-party validation are a key resource, whether from customers, analysts, industry awards, or peer reviews, and they are augmented here with GitLab's own industry research.

Articulating value is a critical sales skill in achieving Command of the Message.

GitLab Proof Points

Customer References and Case Studies

Enterprise

<big>Goldman Sachs</big>

Problem: Needed to increase developer efficiency and software quality

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI/CD, VC&C)

Result: Improved from 1 build every two weeks to over a 1000/day, or releasing 6 times per day per developer, and an average cycle time from branch to merge is now 30 minutes; simplified workflow and simplified administration

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Differentiators: Single App

Usecase: CI, CD, VC&C, Simplify DevOps

Vertical: Financial Services

<big>NVIDIA</big>

Problem: Dispersed development groups faced mirroring issues in time management and security

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI/CD, SCM)

Result: Zero downtime, 51% user growth in 1 year and 99% uptime resulting in increased efficiency

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Differentiators: Single App, CI & CD

Usecase: CI, CD, SCM, Simplify DevOps

Vertical: Technology

<big>Axway</big>

Problem: Legacy CD tool was slow to provide developer feedback and lacked security

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI/CD)

Result: Reduced change failure rate below 15%, and MTTR to less than 2 hours.

Value Drivers: Speed, Efficiency, Security

Differentiators: Single App, SCM & CI

Usecase: CI/CD

Vertical: Computer Software

<big>Hemmersbach</big>

Problem: Multiple tools and communication inefficiencies slowed application delivery

Solution: GitLab Ultimate (Agile, CI, CD, VC&C)

Result: Increased build speed by 59x, 14.4% improvement in cycle time

Value Drivers: Speed

Usecase: CI, CD, VC&C, Agile

Vertical: Technology

<big>Siemens</big>

Problem: Needed to improve and enhance their developer tools

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI)

Result: Actively contributing to GitLab project with upstream commits

Differentiators: Open Source, Collaborative Customer Experience

Vertical: Industrial Manufacturing

<big>Ticketmaster</big>

Problem: Slow build process prevented innovation

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI)

Result: 15x faster - from over 2-hour builds to 8-minute builds; faster releases and better customer experiences with 5 star app reviews

Value Drivers: Speed

Differentiators: Single App, Kubernetes

Usecase: CI

Vertical: Applications Development

<big>Fanatics</big>

Problem: CI pipelines took up so much bandwidth, impacted ability to deliver new tools and features; spent inordinate amount of time on CI maintenance

Solution: GitLab Premium (CI)

Result: GitLab provided the stable CI that Fanatics was looking for, enabling the cloud team to focus on innovation instead of simply fighting fires

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Differentiators: Collaborative

Usecase: CI

Vertical: Retail

Mid-Market

<big>Alteryx</big>

Problem: Legacy developer tools slowed software delivery frequency

Solution: GitLab Ultimate(CI, CD, Security, SCM)

Result: Software builds now 30 minutes from over 3 hours, able to release 9 times a day

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Differentiators: Single App, VC&C & CI, Security

Usecase: CI, CD, VC&C, DevSecOps

Vertical: Technology

<big>Wag!</big>

Problem: Slow release process taking over 40 minutes

Solution: GitLab Ultimate (CI, CD)

Result: Release process reduced to 6 minutes, 8 releases per day with built-in security, and a full deployment pipeline to Amazon Elastic Container Service (ECS)

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Risk

Differentiators: Security, SW Anywhere, Kubernetes

Usecase: CI, CD, GitOps

Vertical: Applications Development

<big>Worldline</big>

Problem: Long cycle times and hard to collaborate between developers

Solution: GitLab Community Edition (VC&C, CI)

Result: From 2 weeks to set up a new project to just minutes, 120x increase in code reviews

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Risk

Usecase: CI, VC&C

Vertical: Financial Services

<big>Extra Hop Networks</big>

Problem: Legacy developer tools prevented collaboration and faster delivery

Solution: GitLab

Result: Unified developers on a common platform, reduced the total number of tools, and eased the transition to CI/CD

Usecase: CI, CD, VC&C

Vertical: IT Management

<big>Hotjar</big>

Problem: Hotjar, a growing all-remote company, was looking for an enhanced CI/CD tool to replace Jenkins

Solution: GitLab Premium

Result: Daily deploys increased from 2 to 15, 30% decrease in time to build GitLab CI vs Jenkins, and 50% deployment time saved

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Usecase: SCM, CI, CD, Kubernetes, All Remote

Vertical: Technology

<big>Chorus</big>

Problem: As Chorus.ai was getting established, they wanted to create an efficient build process

Solution: GitLab Ultimate (SCM, CI, DevSecOps)

Result: 6 week production cycles reduced to 1 week, over 100 builds per day. During a recent audit for SOC2 compliance, the auditors said that Chorus had the fastest auditing process they have seen and most of that is due to the capabilities of GitLab

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed, Security

Usecase: SCM, CI, CD, Security

Vertical: Technology

<big>SVA</big>

Problem: SVA was looking for a platform to improve central code management and workflow CI

Solution: GitLab CE

Result: SVA has over 500 active GitLab users, 110 groups and over 1571 projects

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Differentiators: SCM & CI, Kubernetes

Usecase: SCM, CI, CD

Vertical: Technology Partner

<big>ANWB</big>

Problem: Complex and fragile developer tools hindered productivity

Solution: GitLab Premium (VC&C, CI, CD)

Result: Regular deploys, collaboration, and stable and reliable CI/CD pipelines

Usecase: CI, CD, VC&C

Vertical: Not-for-Profit / Roadside Assistance

<big>Trek10</big>

Problem: Hard to collaborate across silos and with customers on cloud projects

Solution: GitLab Free (CI)

Result: GitLab and its integrated CI helps seamlessly and securely manage deployments across many AWS accounts

Differentiators: SW Anywhere

Usecase: CI

Vertical: IT Services

Industry Awards

The original and internal-to-GitLab proof points Google Doc is online, here while some parts of this handbook page are being approved for publication.

2020

<big>GitLab Recognized by 451 Research as a '451 Firestarter'</big>

The complete DevOps platform delivered as a single application recognized by leading analyst firm for innovation and vision in the technology industry

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed, Risk

Differentiators: Rapid Dev, Simply Dev Ops

<big>Axo Soft - Top 20 Dev Tools for 2019</big>

GitLab is one of the most popular developer tools.

Differentiators: Open Source

Use case VC&C, Agile

<big>Google Cloud Partner Awards</big>

Innovative Solution in Developer Ecosystem for the tight integration with GKE

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed, Risk

Use case Cloud Native

2017

<big>CNCF - The 30 Highest Velocity Open Source Projects</big>

developer velocity can help illuminate promising areas in which to get involved, and what is likely to be the successful platforms over the next several years

Differentiators: Open Source, Rapid Dev

Use case GitOps, Cloud Native

<big>The Forrester Wave: Continuous Delivery And Release Automation, Q2 2020, June 2020</big>

Forrester cite GitLab as a Strong Performer in Wave for CDRA

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Use case SCM, CI, CD, Simplify DevOps

<big>Gartner Magic Quadrant for Enterprise Agile Planning Tools, April 2020</big>

Gartner Cites GitLab as a Visionary in MQ for EAPT

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Differentiators: Visibility

Use case SCM, CI, CD, Simplify DevOps, Agile

<big>Gartner Market Guide for Software Composition Analysis, August 2020</big>

Gartner mentions GitLab in the context of the broader shift in the market toward developers as buyers of tools

Value Drivers: Risk

Use case DevSecOps

2019

<big>Forrester: Manage Your Toolchain Before it Manages You</big>

Multiple tools and toolchains create visibility, security, and productivity challenges for development and operations teams. "Out-of-the-box" toolchain solutions are seen as a solution, increasing security, revenue, and quality.

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed, Risk

Differentiators: Visibility

Use case VC&C, CI, CD, Simplify DevOps

2018

<big>Forrester: Continuous Delivery and Release Automation - Contender</big>

Release automation tools enable faster, higher-quality, more automated software delivery through modeling applications, infrastructure, middleware, and their supporting installation processes and dependencies. "GitLab's release automation is ideal for cloud-native, Kubernetes-centric organizations."

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed

Use case CD

2017

<big>Forrester: Continuous Integration Wave - Leader</big>

Continuous Integration streamlines and accelerates building and testing developer code, shortening delivery to minutes rather than weeks and months. Continuous Integration also automates compliance tasks and improves auditability.

Value Drivers: Efficiency, Speed, Risk

Use case CI

"Perfect solution for cloud and on-premise DevOps tool" · Lead Developer, Mid-Market from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use Case: DevOps, Cloud Native

"Efficient, can trace back, easy to collaborate" · Industry Analyst / Tech Writer, SMB from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use Case: VC&C

GitLab Reports and Studies

<big>2020 Global Developer Report: DevSecOps</big>

Findings Included: A majority of developer respondents, 66%, said their organization does make it possible for them to avoid hacks.
DevSecOps = changing roles: Security can be found on cross-functional teams and working closely in collaboration with developers, both of which represent significant change from the past.

Customer Value: Building security into the DevOps pipeline improves overall security.

Value Drivers: Risk

Use case DevSecOps

<big>2020 Global Developer Report: DevSecOps</big>

Findings Included: CD is real: Nearly 60% deploy multiple times a day, once a day, or once every few days. That's up from 45% last year. And 74% of organizations report they have

shifted testing left, meaning they've moved it earlier into the development process.

Customer Value: Visibility and transparency into future work leads to more efficient planning and execution.

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use case Continuous Integration, Continuous Delivery

Older GitLab Reports and Studies (2019 and beyond)

<big>2019 Global Developer Report: DevSecOps</big>

Findings Included: 50% of developers agree that security vulnerabilities are mostly discovered by the security team after code is merged and in a test environment.

Customer Value: Building security into the DevOps pipeline improves overall security.

Value Drivers: Risk

Use case DevSecOps

2019 Peer Reviews

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"Powerful team collaboration tool for managing software development projects" · Information Technologist, Enterprise from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use Case: SCM

Differentiator: SCM&CI, Single Application

Vertical: Education

<!-- vale handbook.Repetition = NO -->

"Great self-managed, open source source control system" · Administrator, Mid-Market from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use Case: SCM

Differentiator: Software Anywhere, SCM&CI

Vertical: Education

<!-- vale handbook.Repetition = YES -->

"GitLab has helped me master Git, CI/CD pipelines, and software development in general through the many resources it offers. - System Administrator, Mid-Market from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Drivers: Efficiency

Use Case: CI, CD

Differentiator: Single Application, Open Source, SCM&CI, Collaborative

Vertical: Technology

"The UI is better and CI/CD is way more robust. GitLab has also got a great working culture

("remote is the future of work" for sure!) and a very strong brand, and good communication and presence on various platforms. - Marton Nagy, SMB from [G2 Crowd Leader]

Value Driver: Efficiency

Use Case: SCM, CI, CD

Differentiator: SCM&CI, End-to-End Insight

Vertical: Technology

SECTION: sales/commercial/_index.md

Welcome to the Commercial Sales Handbook

The Commercial Sales department is part of the overall GitLab Sales Division. We focus on delivering maximum value to SMB and Mid-Market customers throughout their entire journey with GitLab.

*<i class="fas fa-users fa-fw icon-color font-awesome"></i>*Commercial Team Groups

- SMB Account Executives
- Mid Market Account Executives
- Area Sales Managers

Getting Started as a New Hire

Please ensure you read the Commercial Sales onboarding page.

Top Tips to Onboard Quicker

1. Bookmark the relevant Salesforce dashboard for your region, this is essential to your success. Your Manager will give you the link when you first join.

1. Get familiar with the close date conventions used in Commercial Sales.

1. Ensure you fully understand the Required 7. Your teammates and manager are more than happy to help you with this if you need it.

1. Read through reviews of GitLab to get an idea of what customers think about the product. Two good places to start are Softwareadvice.com and Gartner Reviews.

1. Watching videos is core to your onboarding. You can watch YouTube & Chorus videos at 1.5x or 1.75x speed to get through them efficiently, you can still retain the information but in less time. Go to the Settings widget > Playback speed.

1. When you first start, searching through Slack is a great way to find useful information as it's our primary method of asking questions and announcing things to the company. Some channels that are particularly good for information:

questions

sales

competition

1. Use BuiltWith.com to get an idea of what technologies a customer is using currently (though be sure to verify this with them)

1. You might find it useful to create a Google doc to document all your learnings in your first 30 days, as you will get a lot of information to remember and it will also get you in the habit of taking notes, a key part of GitLab's culture.

1. You can never have too many coffee chats with colleagues. You don't need to ask permission from people, just put some time in their diary.
1. Make sure your calendar is always up to date so that you can get meetings from SDRs without having to moving them around.
1. Listen to as many Chorus calls as possible. They are an excellent way to onboard.
1. Add your own tips to this page as you onboard to pay it forward for the next new rep!
1. Get familiar with GitLab and searching for Issues, MR's and handbook pages. This will significantly speed things up as you progress through onboarding.

Continuous Learning

Below is a list of resources considered highly valuable for continuous learning and development by Commercial Sales team members at GitLab. Note, that some of these resources are not publicly available, so consult a fellow teammate for access where necessary.

- GitLab Direction Includes GitLab's Vision, Maturity framework and planned features and their release dates within each of GitLab's Paid Tiers.
- GitLab Blog Monthly articles on Releases, Engineering, Open Source, Culture and other popular topics of interest.
- GitLab Unfiltered YouTube A YouTube channel private to GitLab employees with video recordings and playlists on company meetings, enablement sessions and other topics. Access GitLab's Sales Enablement playlist.
- Chorus Recordings Our team's history of call and demo recordings is a valuable training resource for new and existing sales team members.
- Sales & SDR Enablement Sessions Weekly training sessions covering popular product, market and sales training topics chosen by the sales and marketing team members.
- Product Study Guide A study course for team members to understand the current full scope of capabilities offered in each tier of GitLab and reasons for tier upgrades.
- Sales Training page
- Commercial Sales Enablement page

Events

When traveling please consider ROI of both any costs plus your time:

If you are going to an event you think first:

- What is the total you will spend for travel?
- What is the total you will spend on food and lodging for me?
- What is the amount you will likely spend on customer meals (meals x customers x of times)?
- How many total business hours will you be away from salesforce?
- 8 hours: then you need to get 5x return on \$, and the fact that any event pipeline closes at about 30%
- How many total personal life hours will you be away from your personal life?

Given the rough calculation above, you've to be committed driving/booking enough Net ARR at the event prior to you going to the event

Note: this doesn't mean you can't get travel approval without booking meetings. It means once you get travel approval it is on you to go get people to the event/meetings to create pipeline.

Trip Notes

The ultimate purpose of attending any GitLab field event is to gain insight and add value. Sid Sijbrandij, our co-founder, talks about the importance of conferences and events here. He believes the main goal of GitLab team participation should always be to connect with our customers and prospects and not to solely attend presentations. Trip notes are our internal process for tracking and capturing this data.

Why and When?

Trip notes are required for the entire Commercial Sales Team anytime a team member travels for the company while working at GitLab. We believe it would be fun and valuable if you also shared trip notes when you traveled for personal reasons; however, that is up to your discretion.

How to properly document your trip notes?

Please follow the best practice process and use the trip note template as a format to prepare for your future trip.

Trip Notes Best Practice

1. Commercial attendee will write up their notes in a google doc.
1. Please save your notes as GitLab internal read only for Commercial Team review in the Commercial Sales Drive Trip Notes Folder.
1. Once saved, please slack and share a link to your notes in the commercialglobalall channel to alert the team of your recent trip.
1. Finally, please share your Post Trip feedback for the entire company and the Field Marketing team directly in the specific Event Issue on the 'Post Event Recap & Feedback' spreadsheet.

Give Back Project

What is the Give Back Project?

- The Give Back Project is a self-selected opportunity to help the Commercial Sales team achieve better results. It is a finite project that, upon completion, is to be adopted by no less than 70% of the Commercial Sales team and used at least once a month.
- The Give Back Project is assigned to all new Commercial Sales team members and is required to be completed as part of their on-boarding process.

Why is there a Give Back Project?

- The goal of the Give Back Project is to allow new team members to be able to instantly contribute to the Commercial Sales team
- Fosters GitLab's values of collaboration and results
- The Give Back Project gives team members the opportunity to be exposed to problems on the team today and will allow the team to look back and see how we addressed shortcomings in the past

How to properly document a Give Back Project

- Give Back Projects are described and worked by team members in the Commercial Sales issue tracker

- If it is something that needs to be repeated (like a customer AMA) an associated handbook entry is created with a description on how a new person could achieve this
- Although the Give Back Project is designed to be finite, there is always room for iteration at GitLab. Be sure to include any necessary instructions on how a different team member would be able to add to your project if necessary

Example Give Back Projects

Customer AMAs: Meetings for GitLab team members with current customers that provide an opportunity to ask them about anything in regard to their experience with GitLab

Customer Meetings: Sharing the best practices for conducting any kind of external meeting at GitLab

Trip Notes: allows team members who attend field events to track and capture data in order for the rest of the team to gain insight

Doing Business with Partners/Channels: Guidelines on how to work with partners and resellers in order to ensure value is maximized in these areas

How to Handle New Customers After They Purchase: Best practices for handling new GitLab customers based on the scope of their purchase

Technical Evaluation of Customers: How to properly evaluate a customer's current technical environment in order to create organizational alignment and prescribe how GitLab can best solve their problems

For a complete list of our Give Back Projects and other Onboarding assignments our team is working on, please click the private link here.

Paid Time Off (PTO) and Results

We have found following steps beneficial to make the process of time off easy for Sales and keep business continuity. This does not serve as a replacement to the company wide Guide to Paid Time Off or add process for Sick Time Policy. This is the expanded approach to preparing yourself and the team for time off planned specific to the group.

- [] Inform Manager as in the GitLab team members guide to time off
- [] Ask a regional team member for coverage and share planned time off
 - Select someone ideally in similar role and who has capacity to cover while OOO
 - It may be helpful to create a shared doc of action items, and follow reference from the handbook
 - There may be cases where double coverage or support from your manager is needed if no one else is available
 - Note: For Family & Friends Day, there is no need for backup coverage as it is a publicly visible shutdown for GitLab. Please message in your below OOO auto-reply as such including the handbook page, and contact details for technical support
- [] Submit time-off in Time Off by Deel in Slack, and add your chosen team member who is covering for you as the assignee role for all tasks, you can label it something like "immediate and general"

- [] Create calendar invite with title:
 - Ex: "First and Last Name OOO - (First and Last Name) is Covering". Optional invite to your manager and person covering.
- [] Block the morning of your return date on your calendar so you can return to work with catch-up time for things like:
 - Re-submitting forecast in Clari
 - Ranking new accounts that came through
 - Respond to email, support tickets, via Required 7
- [] Optionally schedule time on the return day to sync with the individual covering for you

Role responsibilities to prepare being out of office

- [] Any quotes that are currently out to clients, resend via docusign with the person covering for you cc'd on them. Intro AE covering to client in case either have questions via email
- [] Run [this report, edit the dates field in the top right corner to be the dates you are OOO, then select 'run report'. Make sure ZERO next steps are falling on the dates you are out and cover anything not urgent before PTO. This will ensure you leave you without a huge workload for your backup or you in return.
 - If you have an urgent next step scheduled, reach out before vacation, inform the client you will be OOO and get either the person covering for you or your manager included by cc: on the email w/ intro
 - If you have less urgent next steps approaching, assess if they should be handled before or after vacation and then edit the next steps date based on your assessment
- [] Set your email OOO auto-reply including the email of the person covering for you. If your manager is available the days you are out you can add them as well in the email message and any other urgent correspondence

On the day before time off:

- [] Ensure all required 7 reports are up to date
- [] Submit forecast in Clari
- [] Options on phone notifications related to work:
 - Encouraged: Delete apps associated with work such as email and slack
 - Recommended if it is difficult to get these apps back on your phone: Silence notifications on apps associated with work
 - Leave your computer closed and have a blast!

Area Sales Managers have additional steps to consider before leaving for time off:

- [] Set expectations on coverage for 1:1s and team meetings
- [] Updating quote approval routing in SFDC to the person covering for you. Navigate to you name dropdown - My Settings - Personal - Approver Settings. Search for the person covering next to Delegated Approver, confirm and select Save
- [] In Navan, set Vacation Delegate in Settings - Account Details
- [] Submit forecast
 - [] If planned time off exceeds the 25 consecutive days as outlined in the guide, request temporary ASM coverage for forecasting in Clari by submitting a request in the [Sales Operations project.

Role responsibilities of covering for a team member as backup

- Respond within 24 hours to the absent AE's customers if they contact you.
- Address new Required 7 items that appear on your team's Required 7 dashboard for the absent AE.
- Take any urgent customer calls or BDR/SDR calls that have been set up. If you are not able to attend for any reason, you are expected to tell your manager so that appropriate backup can be found. Customer or prospect calls on the calendar should not be delayed or rescheduled.
- Work on and close deals in the absent AE's territory while they are out.

Backup AEs are not required to:

- Cover tasks unrelated to the specific AE role. For example, if the absent AE is a member of a Team Member Resource Group (TMRG), you are not expected to attend TMRG meetings.
- Outbound campaigns to the absent AE's customers (you can if you want to, of course).
- Agree to be a backup if you do not have time to do so, or cover multiple team members. There are other AEs who can help.
- Forecast on behalf of the absent AE. Only update their opportunities as needed.

Required 7

New team members should familiarize themselves with The Required 7. These are the 7 tactical skills required to be an excellent Commercial Sales Account Executive:

1. Ranking your accounts - video here

- Rank all accounts and explain why; log your sources for future efficiency; this needs to be your (recent) ranking, not the previous owners, nor the ranking from the prior fiscal. If it's unchanged, make the note that it is unchanged and why

1. Building your (consider changing the deck) custom deck for any opp amount over \$5k SMB \$10k MM Amount (n.b. amount, not Net ARR) that:

- Calculates the ROI of using GitLab vs. next best option (this might be vs. do nothing)
- Provides the 2 options for the customer going forward - normally both with GitLab (example: Ult or Prem)
- Demonstrates a customised vision for the customer: "what if you used all of GitLab to do DevOps in a single app?"
- Capture the full response, in the customers' words to that vision and the reasons why they think it is possible, or not possible. This capture can be done in the speaker notes so your customer can validate and then copied into an activity after the call.

- video here, and be sure to check out this video on creating an effective ROI slide deck and this supporting deck

1. Capturing key information:

- How did the customer/prospect hear about GitLab and what is their understanding of what we do?
- Meaningful information on why we won/lost a deal

1. Logging your call notes video on taking efficient notes during a meeting and top tips from a top performer here

1. Updating your next steps - video here

1. Command plans, what needs to be filled in:

- \$5k SMB, \$10k MM Amount - All fields in opportunity overview (the whys) and close-plan over this Amount threshold

- \$10k SMB, \$20k MM Net ARR - Full Command Plan over this Net ARR threshold
 - If you don't yet know the answers or have the data, you will populate the Command Plan fields with your script and next steps to get that information
 - Exception to command plan: for channel managed opportunities we may not have access - put Channel-Managed in the opportunity title
 - (training session here and training deck here)
1. Keeping your opportunities up to date at all times video

Account Ranking

It is a requirement for the Commercial Sales Team to tier their accounts using the fields on the Account Object. This helps prioritize the accounts to go after when prospecting for new or expansion. Please see below definitions specific to SMB and Mid-Market AEs.

Ranking Training and Definitions

Commercial Sales: Account Ranking Training Clippet

SMB Account Executive Definitions for Account Ranking

- Rank 1: Top 10 Accounts with new business or upselling possibility within the next 12 months
- Rank 1.5: Future opportunities that we should not lose track of as there is a sales opportunity here with no timeline
- Rank 2: Believe there is an opportunity, but will take additional work before opening and beginning a sales cycle
- Rank 3: Greenfield, SDR attention - perhaps a drip campaign
- SMB AE must have potential user field filled in on the account object for Rank 1, and 1.5
- SMB AE must have the notes section filled in on why an account is Rank 2 or 3

Mid-Market Account Executive Definitions for Account Ranking

- Rank 1: Accounts that I am working to maximize their Net ARR this fiscal year.
- Rank 1.5 The subset of Rank 2 that is best and trending toward being future Rank 1s.
- Rank 2 Accounts that I am working to grow and I speak with them at least once a month.
- Rank 3 Accounts that I keep informed about GitLab and DevOps monthly.

Close Date Conventions

First, forecasting, down to even the opportunity level, is a routine exercise for accuracy, not motivation or aspiration. Each week on Wednesday it is required to update five values in Clari by close of business (5 PM) local time. This is Renewal Loss Best Case, Renewal Loss Best Case, Gross Net ARR Best Case, Gross Net ARR Commit, and Net 50/50. At this time, it is required to double-check pipeline cleanliness and always follow the close date conventions listed here.

1. The close date should always be in the month that you believe it has the most likely chance of closing (with only one exception as dictated below).

1. At all times the Net ARR amount should reflect your best estimate of the actual amount that the opportunity will have on it when it

closes in the month reflected in the close date. There are no exceptions other than returning from an onsite visit, even if you have not spoken with the account. If you get a new opp you should quickly assess the account and, given your experience, make an educated guess on what amount the company will transact at.

1. The Stage represents where you believe the customer is in their buying process, not only the specific steps they have taken with you.

The three close dates:

1. Last day of the month it will close in only if you have a compelling event defined

1. The actual day the opportunity will close when the quote goes out for signature. It will appear past due if we don't get the signature back and pushes to the Friday of the week it should close. Renewals default to this convention

1. First day of the following month, no compelling event defined

1. Placing the close date on the first day of the month is a temporary status of up to 48 hours during which time the AE would work directly with their Champion / Economic Buyer to confirm the compelling event and client timeline. Once determined, the AE would move the close date to the last day of the month of actual closing.

1. This close date carries a window of roughly 60 days of when you think it will come in

Example: It's April 23rd, a new business Mid-Market opportunity is identified for a company at 410 employees and growing at an unknown rate (unclear due to being an agency). The company completed their evaluation with a trial ending this month, there are defined problems initially trying to solve, with some people who have used GitLab before.

- Question for AE and self, what % chance of the purchase occurring in April, May, or June?
- 90% April, 10% May

Chorus recordings

A recording Chorus license is mandatory for all Commercial Account Executives. Our intent is to record customer calls for the following reasons:

- For training, to make sure we are giving customers the best possible experience
- To give to the customer as a visual record of our conversations with them
- To verify any details we may have missed in the conversation

Mandatory steps required to record calls

Follow instructions for using Chorus Scheduler

Deal Reviews

Project 35

As we continue to grow as an organization, developing our sales skills to deliver an impeccable sales experience is a critical component of the customer experience, either leading them to enjoy working with GitLab or not, depending on the quality of that experience. We've created a program called "Project 35" to help you improve your selling skills. We are utilizing our largest opportunities for the quarter to hone in our selling skills with the goal of these skills being valuable on all other sales opportunities.

As part of Project 35 we will be focusing on the following core selling skills:

1. Running excellent sales calls & importance of pre-call prep
1. Stronger discovery to uncover Command Plan (why now, why GitLab, why do anything at all)
1. Building ROI
1. Finding & cultivating champions
1. Negotiation
1. Complex Deal Management
1. Collaboration - amongst peers and leadership
1. Preparation for your next role & large deal management

During a Project 35 call, The AE who is discussing their opportunity will answer the following questions:

1. Prep for a no. What are all the questions or reasons they will say no?
1. Are we building a relationship (onsite, something else?)
1. Nail the project name and the timing of the project (sell services)
1. Selling against a ROI slide
1. Based on the information uncovered in the prior questions, use supporting reasons for AEs to update their next steps live. Managers should enter their comments in the Manager Notes section for any deals they review live or asynchronously.
1. Engage wider sales team. Who are, by name, the CSMs, SAs, Partners that are helping sell the deal. Please assign them to the discussion in the document so that they are able to join the call and contribute to the discussion.

Opportunity Consults and Lightweight Deal Reviews

An Opportunity Consult (OCF) is an in depth, two-way conversation between the AE and the ASM to review the opportunity Command Plan. The AE should expect to provide the ASM with more detailed information about the Opportunity Overview fields, the customer's pain points and desired outcomes, challenges or gaps in qualification aligned to the MEDDPICCC opportunity qualification framework, articulate a Close Plan and identify the biggest opportunity risk(s) and action(s) to mitigate those risks.

A Lightweight Deal Review (LDR) is a shorter (5-10 minute) deal review that is designed to identify gaps in the Command Plan and specific next steps. At the end of an LDR, an AE and ASM should have a plan in place to capture the information that is not in the Command Plan, and a specific plan of action on and before the next call.

Opportunity Next Steps Best Practices

1. Always keep Next Steps Date and Next Steps up to date as an assignment to a future version of yourself on how you will take action to continue the customers buying process.

1. When you start your day you need to check all inputs like email, zendesk, and lead queue so you can triage those requests into your priorities for that day.
1. Allocate times of your day in four ways:
 - Customer meetings scheduled
 - Proactive email and internal efforts
 - Proactive calling efforts
 - Time to check inputs again
1. When beginning a proactive time block, open your opportunities view and sort by Next Steps Date.
1. Your Next Steps should be specific and compelling so that you can take action on them within 3 minutes of reading.
 1. Next Steps should contain **only** the actions you will take next: no dates, no history, just the Next Steps
 1. When you update Next Steps, the Next Steps History will automatically capture your prior Next Steps, applying a date stamp and storing them in reverse-chronological order
 1. Please Note: If you previously included history in the Next Steps field, the next time you update Next Steps you will need to clear the field completely and input only your Next Steps

Opportunity-Specific Slide Deck

It is required that all opportunities above \$10,000 (Mid Market) and \$5,000 (SMB) in total amount (not Net ARR) will have a custom slide deck that is shared with the customer or prospect. The custom deck must be attached to the opportunity by pasting the deck link in the Salesforce field 'Link to Custom Pitch Deck' on the opportunity home page. This will enable Mid Market Account Executives and SMB Account Executives to capture critical account information. Additionally, this will facilitate selling on value rather than features.

Custom Deck Requirements

1. Visual Requirements
 - Deck's main color will match or resemble that of the customer's.
 - Where possible, use the customer's logo.
 - It is appropriate to ask the customer for a blank template.
1. Customer Agreed-upon Agenda
 - When meeting with the customer, leverage an agreed upon agenda to aide in co-selling.
1. Calculated ROI of GitLab v. Next Best Option
 - For New Business the next best option could be 'do nothing' or our competition.
 - For Renewals the next best option could be to go back to what they were doing before.
1. Two options (rough plans) with GitLab going forward
 - For new business this takes the form of Two Lane Selling where we give them a high engagement and a low engagement option.
 - For a renewal, this could be a one year v. a three year option, or Premium v. Ultimate.
1. Non-Custom Single Application pitch to the customer
 - This slide should have a visual representation of using GitLab as a single application for the entire software development life cycle.
 - The intent of this slide is to have the conversation with the customer on 'what is possible', and to capture their feedback

1. Full capture of the customer's feedback on the 'Single Application' slide
 - Capture the customer's actual words in the speaker notes of the 'single application' slide

Red / Green Process and Procedures

Red / Green Purpose

Effective ASM coaching of the why now, why do anything, why GitLab and specific next steps the Account Executive will take with the prospect/client. The goal of the red/green process is to accurately forecast which opportunities will close for each designated fiscal period (Month/Quarter). The red/green process is meant to most acutely build skills around identifying the timeline that is most comfortable for the customer to close.

Red / Green Definition

Designating each opportunity that has a shot to close at the end of each fiscal period as either Red (not going to close before the end of the month), or Green (going to close before the end of the month), and updating manager notes with a defense of the color and a specific next step the AE will complete by the next check in (usually the next day). For context, a green account will have a "why now" that corresponds with a close before the end of the period.

- The threshold (unless otherwise stated) for accounts that will be reviewed during Red/Green is:
 - SMB: \$2,000 NetARR or greater
 - Mid-Market: \$7,000 NetARR or greater

Red / Green Tactics

1. Red/Green meetings are held the 15th (or closest non-weekend day prior to the 15th) of each month, and the last five work days of the month.

1. Area Sale Managers should conduct R/G meetings live with each of their Account Executives. This discussion should not be held asynchronously. Checklist of items below in this order. Advance to next question once prior is confident

- Is this opportunity Red or Green?
- Why do anything at all?
- Why GitLab?
- Why now? (Is there a time-driven reason this opportunity will close within a specific time frame)
- What level is your closest relationship with?
- How can they help you:
 - Get accurate information on the ideal time for the customer to buy GitLab?
 - Get you access to someone else in the organization who has access to the above information?
- What is the AEs immediate next step based on the answer to the items above? If anything less than "wait for account to move from closing to closed-won", then see "Why Now" question.
- An example of a specific next step would be to ask your closest contact: "Is this at all easier for you if we close this next month?"

1. Once Red/Green discussion is complete on the account, the ASM will enter notes in the

"manager notes" section of the opportunity to reflect the discussion and the immediate next step the account executive will take.

1. Repeat the same process the following date for all accounts above the threshold.

Red / Green Outcome

Hit the forecast we commit to and build better sales skills for our AEs and better coaching skills for our ASMs.

- Ideal skills that need to be built are:
 - Understanding the concepts and execution around knowing the ideal timeline the customer wants to close.
 - Identifying pain and having customers understand both the negative impacts of not switching to GitLab as well as the realized positive business outcomes by switching to GitLab.
 - Building a time-bound mutual success plan with the customer based on the severity or the ability for the customer to devote resources to a project.

Red / Green Lookback Process

At the first R/G meeting of the following period, the leadership team will submit their actual closed-won for the prior period as well as their final R/G commitment. Team will then discuss the reasons why each finished where they did and identify any items that led to variation from commitment.

SMB Account Executives

SMB Account Executives "SMB AEs" act as Account Executives and the face of GitLab for SMB prospects and customers. They are the primary point of contact for companies that employ between 1 to 99 employees.

SMB Roles

SMB Account Executives are designated into one of the following pod positions:

1. First Order
1. Pooled
1. Expand
1. Named

SMB Account Executives in First Order will assist prospects in their evaluation through the first buying process. Depending on the account, the other three roles will be the customer's primary point of contact for any renewal and expansion discussions. Collectively the team is responsible for working new business in their territory as well as handling the customer journey for new and existing customers.

AMER SMB Pooled Account Executives are responsible for managing a subset of SMB customers who range from companies on day 1 of using GitLab, all the way to companies who've used GitLab since their day 1. The Pooled AEs work collectively in a "pooled" account ownership model meaning customers are aligned at the team level and all AEs are equipped to help. Pooled AEs work with customers to evaluate product and plan expansion, making recommendations to ensure a

successful renewal with GitLab based on their needs.

Please read below and through the SMB handbook page for more information.

Critical Salesforce reports to follow and bookmark

- SMB AMER Required 7
- SMB APAC/EMEA Required 7
- SMB APAC/EMEA 1:1 Dashboard

New Business

- Work Initial Qualification Meetings IQM's from Commercial SDR Team
- Accept Sales Accepted Opportunities according to SAO Criteria
- Nurture and help prospects during their Trial evaluation after Accepting Opportunities
- Push to Webdirect or help with the Sales Order Process

Customer Journey

- Inbound Queue Management
- Licensing/Subscription Management
- Troubleshooting Resource for Licensing/Subscription Management
- Quotes / Sales Order Processing
- Customer Health Check Process
- Gainsight Data in SFDC Definitions

Inbound Queue Management

Zendesk: Managing incoming requests received through support.gitlab.com

The goal and focus of working Zendesk tickets for the SMB team is to help with upselling and renewals

Within timezone (WIP), the Support team is responsible to take the lead on all incoming ZD tickets in the Upgrades, Renewals, and AR (refunds) queue. In off-hours, the SMB team will triage and handle any tickets which will breach during their timezone.

Support will take the lead on all incoming requests in the queue and only forward to the sales owner when:

- There is an Net ARR affecting event from a customer -OR-
- There is a credit or other request which requires sales manager approval

Salesforce Pipeline Activity

Opportunity Management in Salesforce

- Prior to working a new opportunity always double-check the Account segmentation is "SMB" and the employee count for the company is less than 100, by viewing datafox information and verifying with LinkedIn (especially outside of AMER)

- Direct yourself every day to your Next Steps to know how to prioritize and organize your day.
Recommendations on how to work through your next steps for the day:

1. Sort